

A Hymn of Praise to the Glorious Goddess Sarasvatī

Śrī Devī Sarasvatīstava · Toh 738 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ལྷ་མོ་སྒྲུབ་པའི་བསྐྱེད་པ།

Toh 738 in the Kangyur is a hymn of praise known in Tibetan as "dPal lha mo sgra dbyangs la bstod pa" and dedicated to the glorious goddess Sarasvatī, the Sanskrit name for the divine embodiment of speech, wisdom, and learning. The text is a devotional poem that extols Sarasvatī's supreme mastery over speech and knowledge, celebrating her traversal of the ten bodhisattva grounds and ten perfections as she assumes the burden of enlightened activity for the benefit of all sentient beings. It belongs to the genre of stotra, or hymns of praise, which are found among the dhāraṇī and related liturgical materials of the Kangyur, appearing here directly following a completed dhāraṇī text. As a canonical praise of a major goddess associated with wisdom and the Dharma, it reflects the broader Buddhist integration of Sarasvatī as a protector and embodiment of eloquence and enlightened speech.

The dhāraṇī is complete.

A Hymn of Praise to the Glorious Goddess Sarasvatī

By whatever path the buddhas arise
and the Victors with their sons become supreme lords of Dharma,
by the graduated stages of wisdom through which the grounds are arrayed,
I take refuge in the many maṇḍalas of wisdom.

I bow to you, glorious Goddess Sarasvatī (Skt. Sarasvatī),
who in this world-realm have gained mastery over speech,
who are the sage whose three vidyās have gone beyond knowledge,
and who have arisen from those of vast conduct.

For the sake of sentient beings, the burden of great enlightened activity,
difficult though it is to take up with joy, you have assumed entirely.
By practicing the ten grounds and the ten perfections,
you have transformed the gathered mass of virtue into a wish-granting body.

The maṇḍala of your face blooms like an immaculate moon;
your eyes of compassion open wide, giving sight to wandering beings;
for a long time you have looked with ease upon the entire world.
Before you, the hosts of Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and all the gods bow deeply.

You are loving and patient, the mother who gives birth to compassion,
supreme among goddesses, delighting in guarding all who wander.
Your topknot is high as a mountain peak, your confidence soaring;
your wisdom is profound, and though you are the support of knowledge,
you have gained mastery over the sciences, sovereign of speech,
and in the world you have become a god above the gods.
Because you strive supremely to remove suffering as the highest friend,
even all the logicians of every tradition bow before you.

Your limbs move gracefully and your voice is sweet,
your virtues immaculate, your merit blazing brightly,
and you bestow the supreme accomplishment of the highest knowledge.
Grant me swiftness of mind, the gift of holding words, and supreme eloquence.

You who forever intend benefit for all sentient beings,
most trustworthy and supreme, you dwell on the ground of complete
liberation.

For those who, sustained by sacred commitment, call upon you,
glorious one, hold them in your mind and fulfill their every aim.

Thus all appearances in these pure worlds,
distinguished by speech that dispels confusion and illuminates meaning,
the mutual knowing and the true communication between beings,
all this is your power, Sarasvatī, inconceivable beyond thought.

You who have gained dominion over the power of dhāraṇī and Dharma,
who accomplish the truth of sacred commitment, sage, learned in right
knowing,
you bestow blessings upon body, mind, and speech,
and with a melodious voice you bring satisfaction to the world.

For whoever aspires to the conduct of supreme awakening,
wishing the perfect excellence of self and others to arise,
desiring the supreme purity of body, speech, and mind,
Blessed Lady, always grant the highest aim.

May I be courageous and diligent on the path of awakening,
with faculties of tongue that are pure and speech that is good,
possessed of a treasury of knowledge, unobstructed in speaking,
and may I accomplish the fearless eloquence of the Sugata.

You who are the mother of knowledge, your nature free of conceptual thought,
stirred by the joyous force of the victory banner of sweet sound,
just as one desires to paint many varied forms across the sky,
your defining marks are difficult to fathom —

Translator's Notes

- The final line breaks off mid-sentence in the source text, which appears to be an incomplete transmission of the hymn. The translation renders what is present without fabricating a conclusion.

The phrase "the three vidyās of the sage" refers to the three traditional knowledges attributed to great ṛṣis in the Vedic and Indic tradition, here reframed in a Buddhist context: knowledge of past lives, of the passing away and rebirth of beings, and of the destruction of the defilements. This is a standard laudatory attribution in hymns to Sarasvatī.

The expression rendered "a god above the gods" translates the Tibetan *lha yi lha*, a classical superlative epithet, here applied to Sarasvatī in her exalted status.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.